

Resources (MS Word)

These resources are supplemental references for accessibility concepts covered in this module. These materials are available for optional use.

[Authoring Meaningful Alternative Text](https://www.section508.gov/create/alternative-text/)  [\(https://www.section508.gov/create/alternative-text/\)](https://www.section508.gov/create/alternative-text/)
(Section508)

This resource explains how to **write alt text that communicates intent and function**, not just appearance. It clarifies when alt text is required, when images should be marked decorative, and provides examples that go beyond what Word's Accessibility Checker can evaluate. Use this when adding alt text to ensure descriptions are meaningful and accessible.

[Create Accessible Hypertext Links](https://www.nysed.gov/webaccess/create-accessible-hypertext-links)  [_ \(https://www.nysed.gov/webaccess/create-accessible-hypertext-links\)](https://www.nysed.gov/webaccess/create-accessible-hypertext-links) (New York State Education Department)

This guide focuses on writing **descriptive, screen-reader-friendly link text** and avoiding common mistakes such as “click here.” It ensures links make sense when read out of context, complementing list items or table data that contain hyperlinks.

[Making Tables in Microsoft Word Accessible](https://www.uada.edu/employees/division-accessibility/table-chart-accessibility/word-table.aspx)  [_ \(https://www.uada.edu/employees/division-accessibility/table-chart-accessibility/word-table.aspx\)](https://www.uada.edu/employees/division-accessibility/table-chart-accessibility/word-table.aspx) (University of Arkansas System)

This resource provides detailed guidance on **table structure, header identification, and reading order** in Word. It expands on why certain table designs fail for screen readers and demonstrates best practices that the Quick Guide briefly introduces.

[Improve accessibility with the Accessibility Checker](https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/office/improve-accessibility-with-the-accessibility-checker-a16f6de0-2f39-4a2b-8bd8-5ad801426c7f#bkmk_not)  [_ \(https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/office/improve-accessibility-with-the-accessibility-checker-a16f6de0-2f39-4a2b-8bd8-5ad801426c7f#bkmk_not\)](https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/office/improve-accessibility-with-the-accessibility-checker-a16f6de0-2f39-4a2b-8bd8-5ad801426c7f#bkmk_not) (Microsoft)

This official Microsoft resource explains **how Word's Accessibility Checker works**, what it can and cannot detect, and how to interpret Errors, Warnings, and Tips. It reinforces why manual review is still necessary even after all checker issues are resolved.